

Ohio Truck Factory Layoffs Put Jobs in Focus Before Election

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Nearly 1,400 people were laid off on Wednesday at what had been the Navistar truck factory in Springfield, Ohio. The **layoffs** came three days before President Donald Trump's planned Saturday rally at a nearby high school. Their scale was roughly equal to an entire year of job growth in the greater Dayton area.

Kyle Bos, 30, was among the workers who lost their jobs. He has two daughters, with a third due in January. He said five items at the grocery store now cost as much as a full cart once did. This was his description of the pressure rising prices were putting on his family.

Bos is a United Auto Workers member who describes himself as a **centrist**. He indicated that he had voted for Trump three times, but said he no longer supported the president. The **layoffs** were one reason he planned to spend the final weeks before the November election **canvassing** for Democrats. **Canvassing** means talking with people to seek their votes.

The election will test the support of working-class voters who helped Trump and Republicans win power. In Ohio, Republican Senator Jon Husted faces former Democratic Senator Sherrod Brown. Their race could help determine which party controls the Senate.

The Dayton area has lost about half of its 90,000 factory jobs since 1990, according to federal data. More recently, its economy has improved as Wright-Patterson Air Force Base expanded. The base directly employs 38,000 people, and its innovations have attracted **aerospace** companies, including Electra.

Trump said **manufacturing** was returning during a visit to a Texas truck plant. The White House cited Electra's \$850 million **investment** and announcements from Honda and Stellantis as evidence that Trump's policies were creating jobs.

Jeff Hoagland, CEO of the Dayton Development Coalition, offered a longer view of the area's growth. He said Republicans and Democrats alike had recognized Wright-Patterson's value over the past two decades. He also explained that economic development takes time.

Word Treasure

layoffs -- Job losses that happen when an employer cuts positions.

centrist -- Someone whose political views are generally near the middle.

canvassing -- Talking with people to seek their votes.

aerospace -- Related to aircraft and spacecraft.

investment -- Money put into a business or project to help it develop.

manufacturing -- Making products, often in factories.

Background you need

Canvassing involves talking with people to seek their votes.

The article connects a local employment story with the November election and an Ohio Senate race.

Break it down

Introduces the layoffs, their scale and the planned rally.

Explains Bos's family pressures and changed political support.

Connects the story to an Ohio Senate race.

Describes long-term factory losses and recent aerospace growth.

Closes with attributed claims about policies and economic development.

Why it matters

The layoffs show how employment and household costs can shape voters' concerns, while the area's recent growth provides context for claims about the economy.

Test what you remember

1. How did the layoffs compare with the area's job growth?
 - (A) They roughly equaled a year's growth
 - (B) They roughly equaled a week's growth
 - (C) They roughly equaled a month's growth
 - (D) They roughly equaled a decade's growth
2. What did Bos's grocery comparison describe?
 - (A) Changes in factory hours
 - (B) Growth in aircraft orders
 - (C) Pressure from rising prices
 - (D) Support for Senate candidates
3. What does canvassing mean in the article?
 - (A) Talking with people to seek votes
 - (B) Speaking with companies to sell planes
 - (C) Working with stores to lower prices
 - (D) Meeting with workers to build trucks
4. Who are the candidates in the Ohio Senate race described?
 - (A) Jeff Hoagland and Jon Husted
 - (B) Sherrod Brown and Kyle Bos
 - (C) Jon Husted and Sherrod Brown
 - (D) Kyle Bos and Donald Trump
5. Which investment did the White House cite as evidence of job creation?
 - (A) Honda's \$850 million investment
 - (B) Navistar's \$850 million investment
 - (C) Electra's \$850 million investment
 - (D) Stellantis's \$850 million investment
6. What did Hoagland say about Wright-Patterson's value?
 - (A) Only Republicans had recognized it
 - (B) Only Democrats had recognized it
 - (C) Both parties had recognized it
 - (D) Neither party had recognized it

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: A 4: C 5: C 6: C

Questions to think about

1. **Kyle Bos:** He said he no longer supported Trump and planned to canvass for Democrats, with the layoffs contributing to his decision.
2. **Donald Trump:** He said manufacturing was returning during his visit to a Texas truck plant.
3. **Jeff Hoagland:** He credited recognition of the base's value by both parties over two decades and said economic development takes time.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):